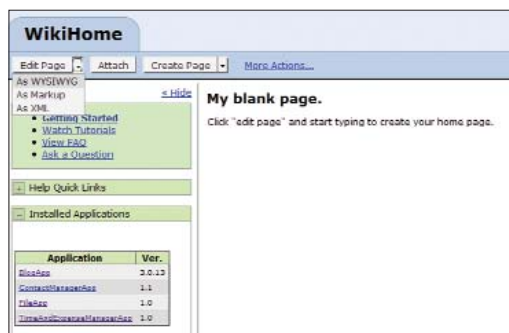




Creating a new page in WYSIWYG, HTML or XML format

WikiWords are two or more words written in title case without any space between them, for instance, NewLink. The Wiki recognises these as links and no HTML is required to link to these words.

Alternatively, you can also use normal words and hyperlink it to the required URL. This however is just a roundabout way of doing things. Creating a link in Wiki using WikiWords is a two-step process. After you finish entering the link name in the template and saving it, you have created what is called a place holder. This is essentially a link to an empty page.

These place holders (see screenshot on the right) are shown as a link with a question mark at the end. To convert them to full links all you need to do is click on them and type in the required text in the template provided. This converts the place holders to links like any other link on the Web. This ensures that adding a new section on a wiki or scheduling a new task which requires creating a new page is as easy as editing content. This mechanism of creating pages by using links makes sure orphan pages (pages that lead to and from nowhere) are not created.

The links could be within the body of the text, or the section heads on your site could be links as well, just as with any regular Web site.

Newer search engines such as MetaWiki allow users to search across a number of wikis

Most wikis on the Web have a non-linear navigational structure, which means that the links to other areas in the wiki are found in the body of the text. This leads to massive cross-linkages, and can be too confusing at times.

In the case of an office wiki, however, a hierarchical navigational structure is preferred. This looks and acts in the same way as a Web site with sections and sub-sections.



Links and place holders are differentiated by their colour

Searching for content on a wiki is similar to doing so on any other intranet. Because of the nature of most wikis—that of being a repository or database of knowledge—search is a very important aspect. The basic search options of title search and full text search is the norm in most setups.

Newer search engines such as MetaWiki allow users to search across a number of wikis. This comes in handy if each department in your workplace were to have its own wiki.

Unlike regular intranets, which require a large amount of installation on the internal server, a wiki can run efficiently with minimal installation on a server or even on individual computers. The content in any wiki is stored on the server as plain text. This makes sure that very minimal server space is needed to store any data.

The wiki engine is the only code that is stored on the machine. The wiki thus acts as a very basic HTML server that translates plain text into a page that can be accessed over any network with all the required formatting. Because of this minimal use of hard-disk space, the wiki can be setup on any computer connected to a network and not just a server as with other Web sites. Thus the Wiki can be classified into two different types as per their installation: server-side wiki and client-side wiki.

Most establishments prefer a server-side wiki, as it makes sure the content is located on

Wikis For Free!

Name of Wiki	Website	Type
Twiki	www.twiki.org	Download from the Net
JotSpot	www.jot.com	Hosted on the Net
Xwiki	www.xwiki.com	Hosted on the Net
TiddlyWiki	www.tiddlywiki.com	Hosted on the Net
Quake Wiki	www.wiki.quakesrc.org	Download from the Net
MediaWiki	www.mediawiki.org	Download from the Net
SeedWiki	www.seedwiki.com	Hosted on the Net

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